
FOR FOUNDERS & STARTUPS

The Startup Pitch Deck Template

10 Slides. Clear Story. Investor-Ready.

A FREE GUIDE FROM

Digital Ninja Technologies

Global Design & Software Development Agency

thedigitalninjatech.com

Most pitch decks fail not because the idea is bad but because the story is unclear. Investors see hundreds of decks. The ones that get meetings are the ones where the problem, solution, and opportunity are unmistakably clear within the first 3 slides. This template gives you the structure that works.

01 Slide 1: The Problem

Your first job is to make the investor feel the problem. Not understand it intellectually. Feel it. The best problem slides make an investor think: yes, I have seen this, or: yes, I know someone with this exact problem.

What goes on this slide

One clear, specific problem statement. One or two data points that show the scale or cost of the problem. One human story or scenario that makes it real. Nothing else.

What to avoid

Do not open with your company name and logo. Do not start with your solution. Do not use industry jargon. Do not put more than 30 words of text on this slide.

Strong vs weak problem statements

Weak: There is a lack of efficient digital payment solutions for freelancers. Strong: Freelancers lose 15 to 20% of their income to payment fees and delays when working with international clients. Most wait 30 to 90 days to get paid.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- [] Problem stated in one clear sentence
- [] Scale of the problem shown with data
- [] Human example included to make it real

Tip: If you cannot explain the problem to a 12-year-old in one sentence, you do not understand it well enough yet. Simplify until you can.

02 Slides 2 and 3: Solution and How It Works

Slide 2 introduces your solution in one clear sentence. Slide 3 shows how it works. These are two separate slides because the idea and the execution are different and both matter.

Slide 2: The solution

One sentence. What does your product do and for whom. Followed by 2 to 3 specific benefits that directly address the problem you just described. A product screenshot or mockup if you have one.

Slide 3: How it works

Show the user journey in 3 to 5 steps. Step 1: sign up and connect your bank account. Step 2: create a contract and set milestones. Step 3: client funds escrow. Step 4: you complete work and release payment. Simple, sequential, visual.

The demo moment

If you have a working product, offer a live demo after your pitch. Nothing builds confidence like seeing the product work in real time.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Solution stated in one sentence
- ☐ 3 to 5 step user journey mapped out
- ☐ Product screenshot or mockup included

Tip: Your solution slide is not the place to list features. It is the place to state the transformation your product creates for the user.

03 Slide 4: Market Size

Investors invest in markets, not just products. A great product in a small market is a lifestyle business. A good product in a massive market is a venture opportunity. Know which one you are pitching and to whom.

TAM, SAM, SOM

Total Addressable Market: the entire market if you had 100% market share. Serviceable Addressable Market: the portion you can realistically reach with your model. Serviceable Obtainable Market: what you can capture in the next 3 to 5 years. Only SAM and SOM matter to most investors.

Use credible sources

Market size numbers without sources are ignored. Use industry reports, government data, or respected research firms. State the source on the slide.

Bottom-up calculation

If top-down data is hard to find, build from the bottom up. There are approximately X businesses of this type in our target market. We estimate they would pay Y per month. That is a Z million dollar market.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ TAM, SAM, and SOM calculated
- ☐ Sources cited for all market data
- ☐ Market size framed in terms of what is realistically capturable

Tip: If your market size is under 100 million dollars, explain clearly why the business is profitable at that scale before pitching to investors seeking large returns.

04 Slides 5 to 7: Traction, Business Model, and Competition

These three slides answer the three questions every investor is asking internally: Is this real? How do you make money? Why will you win?

Slide 5: Traction

Show the evidence that people want this. Paying customers, waitlist sign-ups, revenue, pilot partnerships, letters of intent, usage data, retention rates. Any of these. If you have none, show progress: launched date, users onboarded, feedback received.

Slide 6: Business model

How do you make money? Subscription, transaction fee, one-time purchase, freemium, marketplace, licensing? Show the unit economics: what does it cost to acquire a customer, what do they pay, what is your margin?

Slide 7: Competition

Never say you have no competition. Everything competes with something, even if it is the manual way of doing something. Show a simple matrix or list of alternatives and be clear on what makes you specifically better for your specific customer.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- [] Traction data gathered and ready to present
- [] Business model explained in one sentence
- [] 3 to 5 competitors identified with honest comparison

Tip: Your competitive advantage should be specific, not generic. Fast, affordable, and easy to use are not advantages. They are table stakes. Be specific about what you do that nobody else does.

05 Slides 8, 9, and 10: Team, Ask, and Contact

These final three slides close the story. Investors back people as much as ideas. The ask tells them exactly what you need. The contact slide makes the next step obvious.

Slide 8: The team

Each team member: name, role, and the one most relevant credential or experience. Why is this team uniquely positioned to solve this problem? Relevant industry experience, past exits, technical expertise, and domain knowledge all matter.

Slide 9: The ask

How much are you raising? In what form: equity, SAFE note, convertible note, grant? What will you use it for: product development, hiring, marketing? What milestone will this funding get you to?

Slide 10: Contact and next step

Your name, email, phone, website, and one clear call to action. Would love to schedule a follow-up call. Or: our data room is available upon request. Make it effortless for them to take the next step.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Team slide shows relevant credentials not just names
- ☐ Funding ask is specific with clear use of funds
- ☐ Contact slide has one clear next step

Tip: Practice your pitch until you can deliver it in 10 minutes without looking at the slides. The deck is a visual aid, not a script. If you need to read every slide, you are not ready to pitch.

Ready to build on this foundation?

Digital Ninja Technologies is a global design and software development agency helping businesses and startups worldwide build websites, mobile apps, software, and games that actually work.

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